EarthStick 1.0

User Guide

Fly the real map.

EarthStick gives a Thrustmaster TCA Sidestick Airbus Edition direct control of the ArcGIS Earth camera. Imagery, labels, roads, GIS layers, and offline content remain part of the environment while you move through it.

Neutral controls = stop and hover in place.

Requirements

• Windows 11

• ArcGIS Earth desktop with Automation API enabled

• Python 3.x (tested with Python 3.14.5)

• Thrustmaster TCA Sidestick Airbus Edition connected by USB

• Thrustmaster driver/control panel recommended

• EarthStick.py and EarthStick.bat in the same folder

• No third-party Python packages are required.

Controller check

• Press Win + R and run joy.cpl.

• Select the T.A320 controller.

• Confirm X/Y, twist/rudder, Slider 0, POV up/down, Button 3, and Button 4 respond.

• The tested controller normally appears as T.A320 Pilot.

ArcGIS Earth setup

• Open ArcGIS Earth desktop.

• Open Settings and enable Automation API under Advanced.

• Use the default local API address http://localhost:8000.

Start EarthStick

• Extract EarthStick_v1.0.zip.

• Double-click EarthStick.bat.

• Wait for the console to report ArcGIS Earth: connected.

• Return the stick to neutral before beginning.

Controls

Physical control	Action

Stop EarthStick

Press Ctrl+C in the EarthStick console or close the console window.

Self-test

From a command prompt in the EarthStick folder run: python EarthStick.py --selftest

A successful run prints: EarthStick self-test PASS

Important scope note

EarthStick moves the ArcGIS Earth map camera. It is not an aircraft controller or certified navigation system. Always validate the underlying map, imagery, GIS layers, coordinates, and offline packages for the intended use.